Milen Arro-Cannarsa

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Education

PhD in Economics 2020–2027 (expected)
University of Bern
Advisor: Pierpaolo Benigno
Parental leave 12/2024–08/2025

Swiss Program for Beginning Doctoral Students in Economics 2020–2021
Study Center Gerzensee

MSc in International and Monetary Economics, insigni cum laude 2017–2019
Universities of Bern and Basel
Thesis (Bayesian VAR analysis): "The Effects of the SNB's Balance Sheet Policies on the Swiss Economy after the Financial Crisis" (advisor: Luca Benati)

BSc in Economics, insigni cum laude 2013–2017
University of Bern
Thesis: "Monetary Policy in the Face of Negative Interest Rates" (advisor: Cyril Monnet)

Research Profile

Fields	Monetary Economics, International Macroeconomics, Business-Cycle Analysis and Forecasting
Methods	New Keynesian and DSGE models, optimal policy analysis, time-series econometrics (VARs, Bayesian VARs), machine learning

Honors and Awards

Eesti Pank Research Award, doctoral category 2026
for the job market paper "Flight to Safety: Monetary Policy in an Open Economy"

References

Prof. Pierpaolo Benigno
PhD Supervisor
Professor of Economics
University of Bern
pierpaolo.benigno@unibe.ch
Website

Prof. Martin Brown
Director and Professor of Financial Economics
Study Center Gerzensee
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Website

Dr. Rolf Scheufele
Deputy Head, Forecast and Analysis Switzerland
Swiss National Bank
rolf.scheufele@snb.ch

Research Papers

Flight to Safety: Monetary Policy in an Open Economy Job Market Paper

Nowcasting GDP: What Are the Gains from Machine Learning Algorithms? Working Paper
with Rolf Scheufele. SNB Working Paper 2024-06, Swiss National Bank

Selling Safety: Optimal Monetary Policy for a Reserve Currency Work in Progress

Presentations

2027: Research Seminar, Swiss National Bank (scheduled)

2026: Research Seminar, Bank of Estonia (scheduled); Fourth Women in Central Banking Workshop, Banco de México (scheduled); Alumni Conference, Study Center Gerzensee; Brown Bag Seminar, Study Center Gerzensee; Brown Bag Seminar, University of Bern

2025: Brown Bag Seminar, Study Center Gerzensee

2024: 28th International Conference on Macroeconomic Analysis and International Finance, University of Crete

2023: COMPSTAT 2023, University of London; Brown Bag Seminar, Swiss National Bank; Alumni Conference, Study Center Gerzensee; Brown Bag Seminar, University of Bern

Professional Experience

Study Center Gerzensee, Research Associate and Academic Assistant 2020–present

Swiss National Bank, Business-Cycle Analysis (Konjunktur Schweiz), Intern 2019–2020
Maintained and re-estimated the short-term GDP forecasting models. Responsible for the foreign-trade forecasts for six months. Built high-frequency indicators for the real-time assessment of the COVID-19 shock.

University of Bern, Institute of Marketing and Management, Executive Education Programs, Junior Assistant (40–50%, alongside the BSc and MSc) 2016–2019

Teaching Experience

Study Center Gerzensee, teaching assistant

- Topics in Monetary Economics (central bankers), 2022–2026: K. Adam, G. Benigno, L. J. Christiano, S. Schmitt-Grohé, L. Straub
- Macroeconomic Forecasting (central bankers), 2023: F. Huber, D. Kaufmann, M. Marcellino, B. Rossi
- Instruments of Financial Markets (central bankers), 2022: P. Bacchetta, A. Goyal, N. Herger, B. Nikolov, M. Rockinger
- Financial Stability (central bankers), 2021: P. Bacchetta, M. González-Eiras, N. Herger
- Advanced Topics in Empirical Finance (central bankers), 2021: C. de Vries, T. Foucault, M. Rockinger, N. Schürhoff
- Mathematics (PhD), exercise sessions, 2023, 2024: A. Bachmann, C. Monnet, S. Fukuda
- Econometrics III (PhD), 2022, 2023: M. Watson. Macroeconomics II (PhD), 2022, 2023: F. Alvarez. Microeconomics IV (PhD), 2022: J. Moore

University of Bern, teaching assistant

- Introduction to Statistics II (BSc), 2018–2019: L. Dümbgen

Additional Training

2026 Heterogeneous-Agent NK Models (L. Straub), Study Center Gerzensee
2023 Macroeconomics of Exchange Rates (O. Itskhoki), Study Center Gerzensee
Analyzing DSGE Models with Dynare Julia (M. Juillard), EPFL
2022 Bayesian Methods for Empirical Macroeconomics (G. Koop), Study Center Gerzensee
Introduction to Macro-Finance (A. Mian), Study Center Gerzensee

Skills and Languages

Software MATLAB, Dynare, Python, R, Stata, EViews, Julia, LaTeX, Git, Eikon, Datastream
Languages Estonian (native), German (C2), English (C2), Italian (B1), Russian (B1)
Interests History, literature, ballet, Pilates, skiing